

Here’s a **comprehensive list of Cyber Security Threats**, categorized as **Internal** and **External** — commonly recognized in IT, corporate, and government environments 📄

❑ **1. Internal Cybersecurity Threats**

(Originate from within the organization — employees, contractors, vendors, or systems with internal access.)

Category	Threat Name / Type	Description
Insider Threats	Malicious Insider	An employee or contractor intentionally steals, leaks, or damages data.
	Negligent Insider	User accidentally exposes sensitive data (e.g., weak passwords, phishing clicks).
	Compromised Insider	Employee account is hacked and used by attackers.
Data Threats	Data Leakage	Unintentional or deliberate exposure of confidential information.
	Shadow IT	Employees use unauthorized apps or devices that bypass IT security.
Access Threats	Privilege Misuse	Misuse of elevated admin or database access.
	Unauthorized Access	Using credentials or backdoors to reach restricted systems.
Operational Threats	Poor Patch Management	Failing to update or patch internal systems leads to vulnerabilities.
	Insecure Internal Communication	Using unencrypted email, shared drives, or weak internal network security.
Social Engineering (Internal)	Phishing / Spear Phishing	Employee targeted via email or social message.
	Social Media Oversharing	Revealing internal details that attackers can exploit.
Technical Threats	Misconfiguration	Weak internal firewall or server misconfigurations.

	Unsecured Endpoints	Laptops, USBs, or IoT devices without protection.
Human Factors	Lack of Training	Employees unaware of cyber hygiene practices.
Third-party Risks	Vendor Compromise	Attackers gain access via trusted third-party or supplier.

❑ 2. External Cybersecurity Threats

(Originate from outside the organization — hackers, cybercriminals, competitors, hacktivists, etc.)

Category	Threat Name / Type	Description
Network Attacks	DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service)	Floods servers with traffic to crash or slow them down.
	MITM (Man-in-the-Middle)	Intercepts communication between users and systems.
Malware Attacks	Ransomware	Encrypts files and demands ransom payment.
	Spyware	Secretly gathers information from systems.
	Trojan Horse	Malicious code hidden in legitimate software.
	Worms	Self-replicating malware spreading through networks.
	Viruses	Infects and corrupts system files.
Phishing Attacks	Email Phishing	Fake emails trick users into sharing credentials.
	Smishing / Vishing	SMS or voice-based phishing attempts.
	Clone Phishing	Replicating real messages to deceive users.
Application Attacks	SQL Injection	Attacker manipulates database queries.
	Cross-Site Scripting (XSS)	Injects malicious scripts into web pages.

	Zero-Day Exploits	Attacks using vulnerabilities not yet patched.
Credential Attacks	Brute Force / Dictionary Attack	Tries all possible passwords to gain access.
	Credential Stuffing	Uses leaked credentials from other breaches.
Advanced Threats	APT (Advanced Persistent Threat)	Long-term, stealthy attacks by organized groups.
	Nation-State Attacks	Cyber espionage or sabotage by governments.
Supply Chain Attacks	Software/Hardware Tampering	Attackers compromise suppliers to infiltrate main targets.
Cloud Threats	Cloud Misconfiguration Exploits	Accessing open cloud storage or APIs.
	Account Hijacking	Stealing cloud service credentials.
IoT Threats	Botnets	Networks of compromised IoT devices used for attacks.
	Firmware Exploits	Hacking unpatched smart devices.
Social Engineering (External)	Impersonation / Pretexting	Pretending to be someone trusted to get information.
Physical Threats	Device Theft / Tampering	Physical access to systems or data centers.

□ Summary Comparison

Aspect	Internal Threats	External Threats
Origin	Inside the organization	Outside attackers
Intent	Often accidental or misuse	Mostly intentional
Detection Difficulty	Hard to detect (trusted users)	Easier to detect via firewalls/logs
Examples	Data leaks, privilege misuse	DDoS, ransomware, phishing

Impact Area	Confidentiality, insider trust	Availability, system compromise
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Would you like me to create a **diagram or chart (table or visual flow)** showing **internal vs external threat relationships** for presentations or reports (e.g., for cybersecurity documentation or awareness training)?